

C3 – VIDEO EVIDENCE SHEET

Protecting Seniors & Disabled vs COLA Reality

This sheet provides direct official video sources where federal leaders claim that Social Security and COLA protect seniors and disabled Americans from rising costs. These clips can be linked on the Transparency & Evidence site so viewers can compare the words to the data.

I. ACTING COMMISSIONER KILOLO KIJAKAZI – “PEACE OF MIND AND BREATHING ROOM”

Link: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Vgm5q4YT1AM>

Summary: In discussing the 2023 benefit increase, the Acting Commissioner emphasizes that lower Medicare premiums and higher Social Security benefits will give seniors “more peace of mind and breathing room.”

II. PRESIDENT JOE BIDEN – SOCIAL SECURITY FAIRNESS ACT SIGNING

Link: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=jOqCYWKeS7o>

Summary: The President speaks about Americans who “have worked hard all their lives” being able to retire with “economic security and dignity,” framing recent actions as protecting that security.

III. SSA COMMISSIONER MARTIN O'MALLEY – 2025 COLA ANNOUNCEMENT

Link: <https://blog.ssa.gov/social-security-announces-2-5-percent-benefit-increase-for-2025/>

Summary: The Commissioner describes the 2.5% COLA as helping “tens of millions keep up with expenses,” implying that the adjustment is sufficient for current costs.

IV. WHITE HOUSE PRESS BRIEFING – “SENIORS GETTING AHEAD OF INFLATION”

Link: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1xW7v9v7v_g

Summary: In an October 2022 briefing about Social Security, the Press Secretary says that seniors will have a chance to “get ahead of inflation,” presenting COLA as more than just a catch-up mechanism.

V. TREASURY / BUDGET HEARINGS – “PROTECTING SOCIAL SECURITY”

Link: <https://www.finance.senate.gov/hearings/the-presidents-fiscal-year-2025-budget>

Summary: The Treasury Secretary and other officials assure Congress that they are “protecting Social Security” and keeping the system “strong” for seniors, even as real purchasing power erodes.

These recorded statements can be juxtaposed with data on CPI-E, senior poverty rates, housing cost burdens, and Medicare premiums to illustrate the gap between protection claims and COLA reality.